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ITEM WISE EDITORIALS

38th WEEK



TRUMP & IRAN NUCLEAR DEAL

UPSC CSE – GS II

GS II... EFFECT OF POLICIES AND POLITICS OF DEVELOPED AND DEVELOPING COUNTRIES ON INDIA'S INTERESTS.



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NEWSPAPER EDITORIALS

... DISCUSSION

22nd SEPTEMBER, 2017

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Nuclear deal in danger

Trump's continued tirade against Iran undermines the non-proliferation regime

U.S. President Donald Trump's opposition to the Iran nuclear deal is not new. But by choosing his first address at the UN General Assembly, in which he listed his administration's foreign policy priorities, to slam Tehran and the nuclear accord, he has put to rest any hope for improvement in ties with Iran. In his tirade on Tuesday, he called the Iran deal, which the U.S. and five other countries had signed with Tehran two years ago, an "embarrassment", and "one of the worst and most one-sided transactions the United States has ever entered into". Unsurprisingly, it triggered a reaction from Iran. Iranian Foreign Minister Javad Zarif called out Mr. Trump's "ignorant hate speech", which he said belonged to "medieval times". The message from the Trump administration is clear and consistent: the Obama-era pragmatism was an aberration and the decades-old hostility between the U.S. and the theocratic regime in Tehran stands resumed. The real test before Mr. Trump and the Iranians comes in less than a month. According to U.S. law, the administration must certify the Iran deal every 90 days. The Trump administration has twice done so, and the next deadline is October 15. Mr. Trump has already signalled that he would withdraw the certification next time. If he does so, it would be the beginning of the unravelling of an agreement that was forged after intense negotiation.

Failure of the U.S. to respect an international agreement it's a signatory to would set a dangerous precedent. For all its shortcomings, the Iran nuclear deal is a multilateral agreement. And it has shown results. What had appeared to be an irresolvable issue only three years ago is now settled. International agencies have repeatedly certified that Iran is fully compliant with the terms of the agreement, which means the country is not pursuing any nuclear weapons programme. In plain terms, the deal is a success as it prevented a country with potential nuclear capabilities from developing weapons, and all this without a shot being fired. If the U.S. is serious about non-proliferation, it should use the Iran deal to resolve other complex international conflicts. What's happening is just the contrary. Iran has been slapped with more sanctions by the U.S. over its missile programme. If Iran is not spared even after it agreed to give up a substantial part of its nuclear programme under a multilateral agreement, what message does it send to other countries about international diplomacy? No doubt, Mr. Trump's continued attack on the Iran deal pleases hard-line supporters at home as well as Arab allies and Israel in West Asia. But it is undermining the global non-proliferation regime and international institutions.

2 Nuclear deal in danger

Trump's continued tirade against Iran undermines the non-proliferation regime

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2 Nuclear deal in danger

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DONALD TRUMP AND IRAN NUCLEAR DEAL

- 1** In the first address to UN General Assembly, the USA President slammed Iran and the nuclear accord.
- 2** This almost closed the hope for any improvement in ties with Iran.
- 3** The President said that, it is one of the worst and most one- sided transactions, the United States has entered into.
- 4** Iran called Trump's speech as "ignorant hate speech" and belongs to medieval times.





BARACK OBAMA
Former President, USA

HOW TO VIEW THIS?

The message is that the pragmatism shown by Barack Obama against the decade old rival Iran looks like an **aberration**. Now it appears that the decade old hostility between the United States and the **theocratic** regime in Tehran stands resumed.



DONALD TRUMP
President, USA



REAL TEST ON OCTOBER 15th

- 1 According to US law, the administration must certify the Iran deal every 90 days.
- 2 The Trump administration has done twice previously.
- 3 The next deadline is on October 15th.
- 4 Mr. Trump already signalled that he would withdraw the certification next time.
- 5 If he does so, it would be the beginning of the unravelling of an agreement that was forged after intense negotiations.



RESPECT OF INTERNATIONAL AGREEMENTS... DANGEROUS PRECEDENT

- 1 Failure of US to respect an International agreement would set a dangerous precedent.
- 2 The Iran nuclear deal is a multi-lateral agreement. In fact, it has shown results. International agencies have repeatedly certified that Iran is fully compliant with the terms of the agreement, which indicates that the country is not pursuing any nuclear weapons programme.

The deal is a success as it prevented a country with potential nuclear capabilities from developing the weapons.



WHAT SHOULD BE THE INTENDED ACTION?

- 1 If at all, US is serious about non-proliferation, it should use the Iran deal to resolve other complex International conflicts.
- 2 What is being happened is, Iran is slapped with more sanctions by the US over its missile programme.

Even if Iran is not spared after it agreed to give up its substantial part of its nuclear program under a multi lateral agreement, what message is given by the USA to the World as a Whole?



DONALD TRUMP
President, USA

Mr. Trump's continuous attack on the Iran deal, pleases hard line supporters in USA as well as Arab allies and Israel in West Asia. But it undermines the Global non-proliferation regime and International Institutions.

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SINCERE THANKS
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